

Javed Akhtar

Senior Director of Customer Service · AI-First CX & Operations Leader

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SUMMARY

AI-first Customer Experience and Operations leader with 13+ years building scalable, data-driven customer operations across EdTech, SaaS and PropTech. I believe exceptional customer experience sits where AI, intelligent process design and human insight meet. I lead a 25+ person team and have moved support from reactive to a proactive, AI-powered retention engine, using automation, SQL and API integrations to turn customer data into decisions. I run teams against quality, productivity and service-level targets and plan their capacity, shifts and work allocation. I have worked with globally distributed teams for 5+ years and am open to night-shift, in-office work in Bengaluru.

CORE SKILLS

Team leadership	Coaching, performance reviews, hiring, onboarding, training, escalation management
Operations	Workforce planning, capacity management, shift scheduling, SLA/quality/productivity management, SOPs
Data & systems	SQL, Redash, Postgres, Python, API integrations, ETL, dashboards, AI agents and AI briefs (Claude)
Tools	Atlas, Intercom, Freshdesk, Zendesk, Slack, Airtable, Monday.com, Livechat

EXPERIENCE

Senior Director of Customer Service

Oct 2024 – Present

Codingal (EdTech, YC W21) · Bengaluru

- Lead a 25+ person support, retention and success team handling 1,200 WhatsApp chats, 500 website chat messages and 300 emails a day. Plan capacity, scheduling and work allocation to meet service levels.
- Hold 90%+ CSAT on chat and above 85% on email, with first response under 2 min on chat and 60 min on email, and average resolution under 48 hours.
- Cut monthly churn from 16% to 9%. Raised trial-to-completion from 44% to 56% and course completion from 15% to 25%.
- Built a support data platform: a Python and Cloudflare pipeline syncs every ticket into a Postgres warehouse that feeds all dashboards, agents and reports. Write the SQL and Redash queries the team runs on.
- Deployed live AI agents (trial enquiries, paid-course Q&A, teacher payouts) with automatic hand-off to a human. Built a daily AI quality-audit and AI briefs that score ticket handling before each shift.
- Integrated Atlas, Slack, Airtable, Redash and Google Sheets through their APIs to automate reporting, lead feedback and the monthly incentive payout.
- Wrote company-wide SOPs, escalation frameworks and a knowledge base. Work with product and engineering to turn ticket trends into roadmap changes.

Director of Customer Service

Oct 2023 – Oct 2024

Codingal · Bengaluru

- Built the support function from scratch: team structure, CRM and ticketing setup, SLA frameworks and the first CSAT measurement across all channels.
- Designed churn-signal playbooks and retention workflows. Aligned support with sales, product and teacher operations.

Customer Success Manager

Sep 2018 – Oct 2023

CasaOne (PropTech, Furniture-as-a-Service) · Bengaluru

- First Customer Success hire at an 8-person company. Built the team, processes, KPIs and tool stack, including hiring criteria, onboarding and performance coaching.
- Worked with globally distributed teams across time zones for 5+ years.
- Tracked NPS, CSAT, first-contact resolution, missed-call rate, call wait time and ticket and chat resolution time. Ran NPS programmes, customer interviews and churn reduction.
- Cut failed installations and re-delivery runs by profiling lift, doorway and room dimensions before delivery.
- Administered and trained teams on Zendesk, Slack, Monday.com, DocuSign, Livechat, Textline and DispatchTrack.

Customer Experience Manager

Feb 2018 – Sep 2018

Bicycle AI · Bengaluru

- Automated and streamlined support processes, cutting customer complaints by 30% and avoiding extra headcount. Hired and led the team.

Customer Experience Manager

Sep 2016 – Feb 2018

Furlenco (FurnitureTech) · Bengaluru

- Lifted customer retention by 20% and upsell revenue by 10% through loyalty programmes and better interactions.
- Wrote policies and SOPs for delayed deliveries and damaged-furniture pickups.

Technical Support Engineer

Jan 2016 – Jul 2016

Convergys · Greater Delhi

- Resolved customer issues within SLA and trained new joiners.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Hardware & Networking · Gandhi Engineering College**LANGUAGES**

English, Hindi, Oriya